



ADULT SEXUAL PRACTICE & PATTERNING

NURS 280 JUNE 9, 2026



ADULT SEXUAL DEVELOPMENT

- Often seeking long-term romantic/sexual relationships (notsomuch marriage, these days)

Adults are learning:

- How to sustain relationships beyond a passionate start

Adults are developing:

- Effective communication methods
- Sexual health protection/maintenance



DATING & RELATIONSHIPS

Dating & relationship styles to discuss:

- serial monogamy
- polyamory
- casual dating
- hookups
- unethical nonmonogamy
- others?



ADULTS: SOLO SEXUAL BEHAVIOURS

Sexual fantasies are extremely common, during solo and partnered activities. While most people report fantasizing about someone other than their partner, at least occasionally (98% of men; 80% of women), only some of us think that is acceptable (52% of men; 40% of women)

Leitenberg, H., & Hicks, T. V. (2001). Sexual fantasies about one's partner versus someone else: Gender differences in incidence and frequency. *The Journal of Sex Research*, 38, 43-50.



ADULTS: SOLO SEXUAL BEHAVIOURS

Justin Lehmiller has researched and written extensively on fantasy. He reports that sex with multiple partners is a very common fantasy, followed by sadomasochism.

Most fantasies are not acted upon: less than 1/3 of respondents had acted out their “biggest” fantasy scenario



ADULTS: SOLO SEXUAL BEHAVIOURS

Masturbation (self-pleasuring) has been observed in hundreds of non-human species. Historically, non-procreative sex has been seen as sinful by many cultures. Techniques to prevent masturbation have ranged from punishment to control through diet. Twice as many adult cis men than women reported masturbating in the last month; men report viewing porn during masturbation more than women. About half of adults report using a vibrator during sex play.



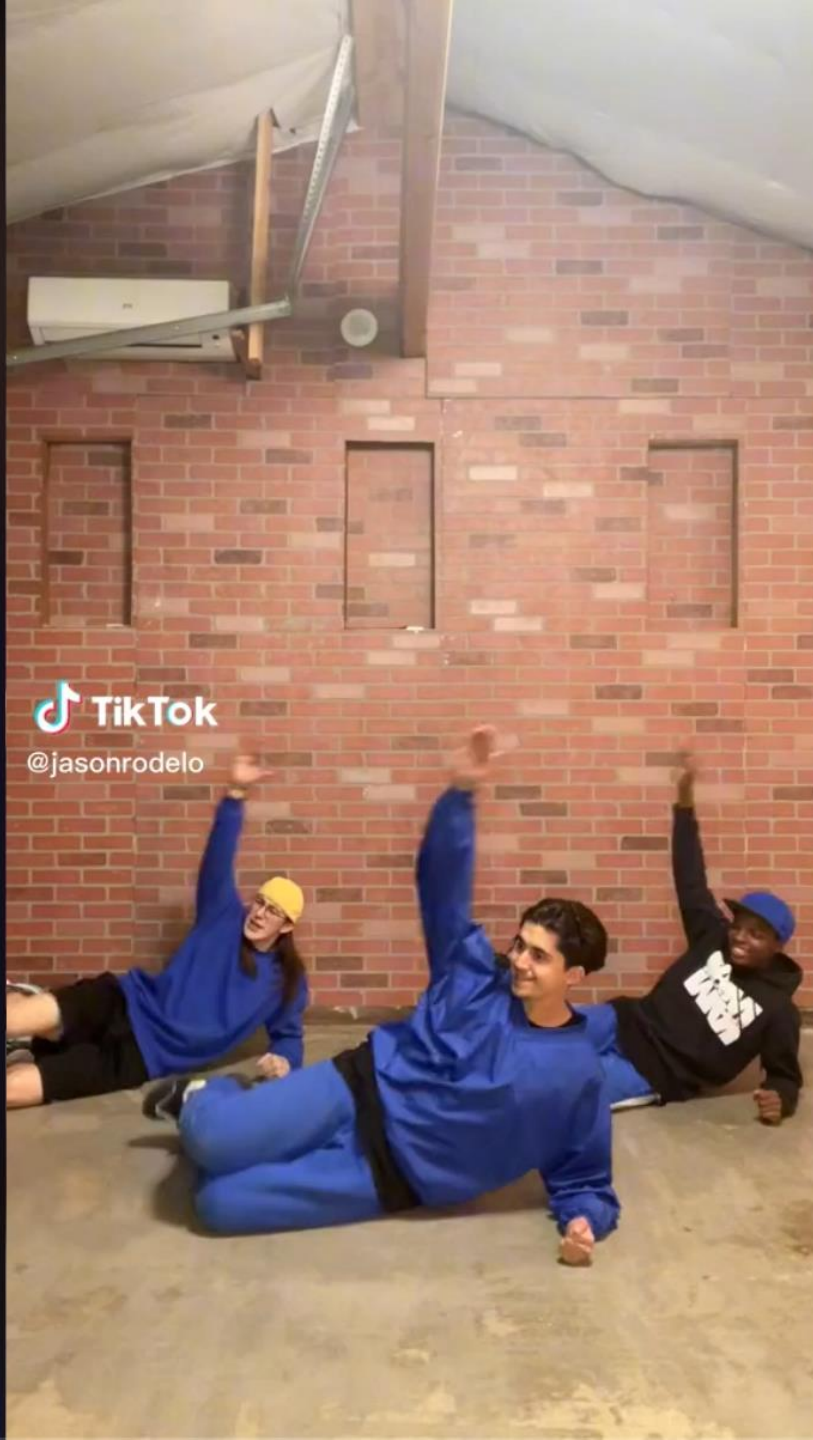


The rules of No Nut November:

- You cannot have sex, masturbate, or nut in any way, shape or form
- Watching pornography and having boners are allowed, but you can't nut
- You are only allowed one wet dream. If you have more than one, then consider yourself out.
- You do not have 3 strikes; you only have one shot at it. If you miss it, you're out.
- If you have passed the month with a total of 0 nuts, you are a victor and you shall qualify for Destroy Dick December (Not Recommended)
- Look, man, just don't nut in 30 days.

Urban Dictionary





 TikTok
@jasonrodelo



470.3K



1916



17.8K



00:00/00:35





Ashley Winter MD || Urologist

@AshleyGWinter



As a urologist I would like to remind everyone that "No-nut-November" is predicated on complete falsehoods about the physiology of ejaculation. [#nofap](#)
[#NoFap2022](#)



Ashley Winter MD || Urologist @AshleyGWinter · Nov 3



Replying to [@AshleyGWinter](#)

There are zero health benefits to forcing yourself to not ejaculate for a month. Literally zero. If someone is quoting a study, they have misunderstood the study.



30



129



1,231



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Like yes, if you are locked in your basement masturbating 10 hrs a day that might not lead to a deeply joyful life, but NOT ejaculating for a month is NOT going to give you higher T levels or extra success in life.



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89



1,380



IS MASTURBATION GOOD FOR YOU?



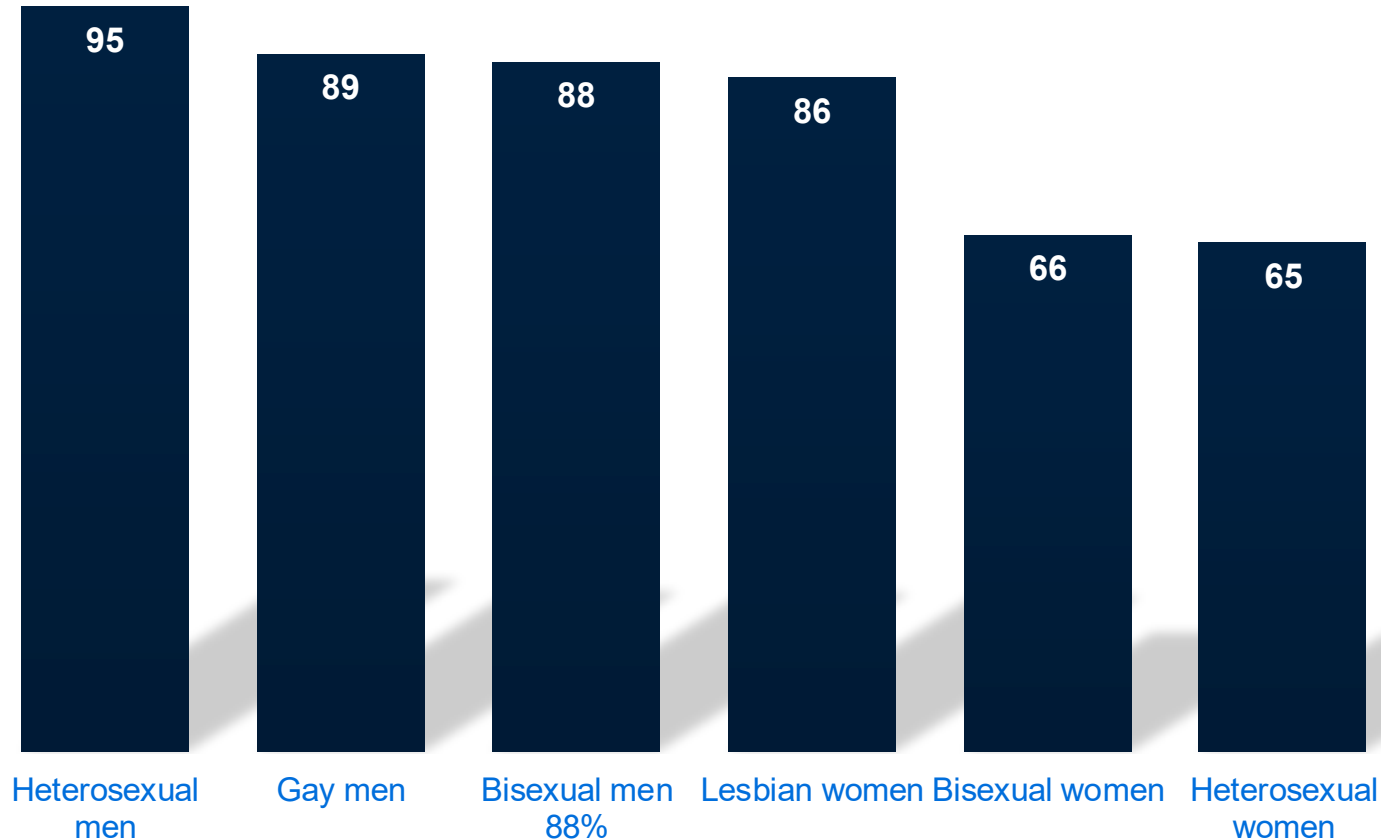
ADULTS: PARTNERED SEXUAL BEHAVIOURS

- **Foreplay** is a problematic term, still used to describe non-penetrative sex
 - Kissing
 - Touching
 - Breast/nipple play
 - Oral sex
 - Etc.!!!
- **Intercourse** usually refers to penis-vagina sex. Many positions and angles are practiced.
- **Anal sex** is often considered/described as a gay male sexual activity, but many genders and couples report enjoying anal sex.



THE ORGASM GAP

I usually/always orgasm during sex with a partner



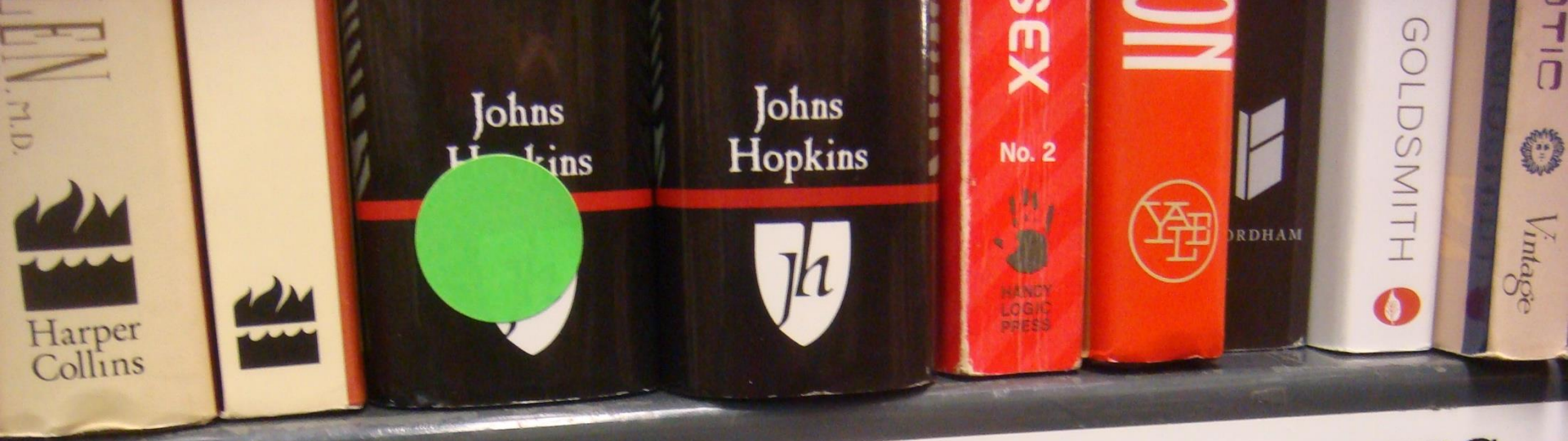
Frederick, D.A., John, H.K.S., Garcia, J.R. *et al.* Differences in Orgasm Frequency Among Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual, and Heterosexual Men and Women in a U.S. National Sample. *Arch Sex Behav* **47**, 273–288 (2018). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10508-017-0939-z>



SEXUAL DYSFUNCTION

- **Low desire/nonconcordant desire** is commonly reported to sex therapists. **Dr. Lori Brotto** has spent her career developing tests and interventions for women
- **Pre-orgasmia** is mostly diagnosed in cis women, though men may also have trouble reaching orgasm. **Erectile difficulties** are more studied in cis men.
- **Sexual pain** often stems from genital pain, such as dyspareunia (painful intercourse) vulvodynia (vulva pain) or vaginismus (pain from tight muscles around the vulva).
- **Treatments** may involve psychotherapy, mindfulness practices, physiotherapy, touch therapy, and/or drug therapy.





SEXUALITY CONTINUES



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

